Self-hosted Chained VPN Setup

Recommended VPN Options

- **Tinc VPN**
  Tinc is designed for creating mesh networks. It allows each node to dynamically connect to every other node, making it ideal for bridging servers in a chain or a more complex network topology. Its configuration is flexible enough to handle routing between multiple nodes without needing overly complex manual setups.

- **OpenVPN**
  OpenVPN is a very popular open source solution that can be configured in either routed or bridged modes. While it's not inherently a mesh VPN, you can set up multiple tunnels between servers to create a chained connection. However, this might require more manual configuration compared to Tinc.

- **WireGuard**
  WireGuard offers a modern, lightweight alternative with high performance and simplicity. It is primarily designed for point-to-point connections, so creating a mesh network or a chained VPN would require additional routing configuration. If performance and modern cryptography are key priorities, it's worth exploring.

- **SoftEther VPN**
  SoftEther supports multiple VPN protocols and has robust bridging capabilities. It's versatile and can be configured for complex topologies like chained VPNs, though it might be a bit heavier in terms of resource usage compared to the other options.

Considerations for a Chained VPN Setup

- **Network Topology:**
  Determine how many nodes you plan to connect and whether you need a full mesh (each server connects to every other) or a more linear chain. Tinc naturally supports full mesh networking, which can simplify the setup if your use case fits that model.

- **Security Requirements:**
  Each VPN option offers robust encryption, but you might choose one over another based on ease of integration with your existing security protocols and your performance needs.

- **Ease of Configuration & Maintenance:**
  Tinc is often favored for scenarios like yours because it automatically handles routing between nodes. OpenVPN and WireGuard might require more hands-on configuration for routing traffic in a chained manner.

Next Steps

- **Define Your Requirements:**
  It would help to know more about the number of servers you're planning to bridge, expected traffic, and specific routing needs (e.g., do you need redundancy, load balancing, etc.?).
- **Test Environment:**
  Consider setting up a test network with one or two of these solutions to see which fits your environment best.
- **Documentation & Community:**
  All these options have active communities and robust documentation. Reviewing their setup guides can provide further clarity on which is best for your use case.